Dear Editors,

We submit "Hard to Beat: Historical Rules versus Conditional Quantile Models for Peak Net-Position Limits" to Journal of Forecasting. The comparative application asks whether conditioning improves matched peak forecasts, transfers across reporting systems, and lowers limit costs.

Matched regression lowers FX loss by 14.8% and 16.6% across retrospective periods. Earlier loss instead rises by 3.2% against the original shorter rolling reference. Historical rules remain competitive at lower frequencies. In 17 eligible CFTC futures categories, F or I beats expanded regression in 29 of 34 comparisons. Matched F/I survives in 90 of 98 model confidence sets, usually alongside alternatives.

The contribution is empirical comparison with explicit procedure and reference controls. Paired calibrated simulations remove the large short-history median loss after menu expansion; the registered switching increment remains unsupported. Separate reserve, breach-frequency and excess charges produce different cost-ranking regions. The forecasting, MCS and cost-accounting methods are established. The transferable validation lesson fixes mature-label timing, history and update schedules before comparing complete tuning procedures. Scores, hits and cost preferences retain separate interpretations.

The independent CFTC reporting system supplies aggregate categories, not independent individual dealers. Daily aggregation uses the same FX record. Earlier and later comparisons remain retrospective. Failed simulation cells, unsuccessful predictions and unavailable methods are retained, with no favourable subset substitutions.

The materials include native manuscript, Supplement, title-page template, complete saved aggregate results and versioned code. Official CFTC archives include complete source fingerprints. Raw FX observations and private per-issue vectors remain excluded. Authors must complete authorship, permissions and all declarations before submission.

Sincerely,

[TO BE COMPLETED BY AUTHOR]